

António Pedro Dias da Costa

Doctoral Researcher · Faculty of Psychology and Educational Sciences, University of Porto · CIDTFF – University of Aveiro · LIACC – University of Porto

Qualitative Research, Mixed Methods and Human-AI Collaboration applied to Education. Co-author of the webQDA software and coordinator of the Ibero-American Congress on Qualitative Research (CIAIQ) and the World Conference on Qualitative Research (WCQR).

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ABOUT

Doctoral researcher, currently at the Faculty of Psychology and Educational Sciences, University of Porto, with a long-standing link to the Research Centre on Didactics and Technology in the Education of Trainers (CIDTFF – University of Aveiro) and to the Artificial Intelligence and Computer Science Laboratory (LIACC – University of Porto). He has been active in scientific research for over two decades at the intersection of Education, digital technologies and research methodologies, with a recent focus on the critical, ethical and responsible use of artificial intelligence — including large language models — in higher education and scientific research contexts.

PhD in Multimedia in Education from the University of Aveiro, with a postdoctoral fellowship in qualitative research applied to Education and a background in Communication Engineering. He is author and editor of more than 300 scientific publications. He has coordinated, since their creation, two of the leading international events in qualitative research: CIAIQ and WCQR.

300+

Publications

76

Journal articles

50

Conference papers

44

Events organised

20+

Years of activity

PROFESSIONAL CAREER

2026 – present

Doctoral Researcher (level 2), Faculty of Psychology and Educational Sciences, University of Porto

2023 – 2026

Doctoral Researcher (level 3), University of Aveiro

Project “Collaborative and automated processes for qualitative research in Education” · DOI: 10.54499/CEECINST/00013/2021/CP2779/CT0011

2013 – 2026

Integrated Member and Scientific Council Member, CIDTFF – University of Aveiro

Digital Content Laboratory (LCD), Department of Education and Psychology

2008 – 2026

Collaborator, LIACC – Faculty of Engineering, University of Porto

2004 – present

Co-founder, Ludomedia Unipessoal Lda.

Intellectual and pedagogical lead · Oliveira de Azeméis · www.ludomedia.org

2000 – 2006

Co-founder and General Director, ArteVirtual

Information and Communication Technology venture, Oliveira de Azeméis

ACADEMIC EDUCATION

2018

Postdoctoral Fellowship – University of Aveiro

"Implementation and Evaluation of Instruments for Qualitative Analysis in Education Research" · grant SFRH/BPD/104288/2014

2012

PhD in Multimedia in Education – University of Aveiro

Thesis: "Hybrid User-Centred Development Methodology Applied to Educational Software"

2003

Specialisation Course in Multimedia in Education – University of Aveiro

2002

Bachelor's Degree in Communication Engineering (Communication and Design) – Universidade Fernando Pessoa

Certified Trainer, Scientific-Pedagogical Council for Continuing Education (CCPFC/RFO – 17976/04, since 2004).

RESEARCH AREAS

Human-AI Collaboration · Qualitative Research · Mixed Methods · Qualitative Data Analysis · webQDA Software · Visual Methods · User-Centred Design · Research Ethics and Integrity · Educational Technologies

Currently involved in international scientific projects and networks, including the Erasmus+ EDUAI project, COST Action CA24121 (Knowledge Graphs in the Era of Large Language Models), and collaborations with the National Academy of Sciences of Ukraine / UNESCO Chair on AI in Education.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Full list (300+ works) available on Google Scholar and ORCID.

2025 – Costa, A. P., Bryda, G., Christou, P. A., & Kasperuniene, J. AI as a Co-researcher in the Qualitative Research Workflow. *International Journal of Qualitative Methods*, 24.

2025 – Costa, A. P., Burneo, P., & Kasperuniene, J. Mixed-methods & AI for Methodological Literature Reviews. *The Qualitative Report*, 30(10), 4515–4540.

2025 – Pinho, I., Costa, A. P., & Pinho, C. Generative AI Governance Model in Educational Research. *Frontiers in Education*, 10.

2024 – Petre, G.-E., & Costa, A. P. Advancing Qualitative Research: Insights from the 7th World Conference on Qualitative Research. *Social Sciences*, 13(1).

2023 – Bryda, G., & Costa, A. P. Qualitative Research in Digital Era: Innovations, Methodologies and Collaborations. *Social Sciences*, 12(10), 570.

2023 – Costa, A. P. Qualitative Research Methods: do digital tools open promising trends? *Revista Lusófona de Educação*, 59(59), 67–76.

2020 – Brandão, C., & Costa, A. P. Reflecting on CAQDAS and Ethics. *The Qualitative Report*, 25(13), 1–5.

2019 – Costa, A. P., & Moreira, A. Technology ethics in qualitative research: How to be. *The Qualitative Report*, 24(13).

2019 – Costa, A. P., & Minayo, M. C. de S. Building criteria to evaluate qualitative research papers. *Revista da Escola de Enfermagem da USP*, 53, 1–7.

TEACHING

2025/2026

University of Aveiro

Research Methodologies in Multimedia in Education · Research Methodologies in Education (Doctoral Programmes)

2014 – 2024

University of Aveiro, Universidade Lusófona do Porto, ISLA, ISVOUGA

Research Methodologies in master's, doctoral and postgraduate programmes

2001 – 2003

Instituto Piaget

Multimedia Educational Communication and New Communication Techniques

Since 2010, he has coordinated training around the webQDA software, having run dozens of courses and workshops in Portugal, Spain, Brazil, Croatia and Jordan, among other countries.

SCIENTIFIC SERVICE

Event Organisation (selection)

- Co-organiser, 9th World Conference on Qualitative Research (WCQR2026), Madrid
- Co-organiser, 14th Ibero-American Congress on Qualitative Research, Porto (2025)
- Co-organiser, 2nd AI in Education Forum, University of Aveiro (2025)
- Founding coordinator of CIAIQ (14 editions) and WCQR (9 editions)

Scientific Bodies and Committees

- Member of the Scientific Council, CIIE – University of Porto (2026–)
 - Member of the Scientific Committee, PhD in Education, ISCED-Huíla, Angola (2025–)
 - Member of the Scientific Council, CIDTFF – University of Aveiro (2013–2026)
 - Member of the Editorial Board, The Qualitative Report (2025–)
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AWARDS AND DISTINCTIONS

- Honourable Mention, Arts and Humanities, “UA Researcher Award” (2022)
- Biannual Book in Spanish or Portuguese, ICQI Award (2016)